A PERSONAL BRAND FROM ZERO · BY ALLAIA



6.8 million views in 90 days. This is exactly what I did.

Paid *to exist.*

Hotels, brands and music labels pay women to post their life online. Nobody tells you how. This book does, starting from zero.

01 Free stays in five-star hotels

02 Free products sent to your door

03 Paid to use songs in your Reels

04 Paid brand deals

ALLAIA MEDIA

BALI · DUBAI

PAID TO EXIST

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Every figure in this book comes from my own Instagram Insights, captured in 2026. Your numbers will be different. Results depend on the work you do, the market you are in and the platforms on the day you post. Nothing here is a guarantee of income.

Paid and gifted content must be disclosed where you live. Chapter Twelve explains how.

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HOW IT STARTED · DUBAI, MARCH 2026

I was bored. And a little lost.

Nine months ago, if someone had told me I would be paid to do the things I already do every day, I would not have believed it. Or maybe I would have.

Back in March 2026 I started experimenting with social media, mostly my Instagram. Just posting Reels. Honestly, I did not start because I thought, I want to be a content creator. I started because I was bored, and a bit lost on my career path.

I was in real estate in Dubai. Fresh, in a new market. Before that I had spent five years in real estate in Manila, in the Philippines, and three years in B2B digital marketing. Getting back into real estate somewhere new, I kept getting the same feeling. The corporate world was not for me anymore.

But what I have always been is an artist.

Ever since I was a kid. I loved to write. Essays, poems, even novels and short stories. I loved to paint and to draw. I love editing videos, taking something raw and turning it into something. I like creating. That is the whole thing.

So I experimented. I made Reels with no expectations and no clear goal in my head.

My first few Reels in Dubai went viral. They were not about luxury, wellness or brands. They were about what was happening in Dubai at that time, the war tensions. Me sharing my take, sometimes making light of the situation. I was simply sharing what was happening in my life.

And the collabs came immediately.

Restaurants and cafés in Dubai. A table at At.mosphere, on the 122nd floor of the Burj Khalifa. Then Bali, Bangkok, five-star resorts, private villas, fashion labels, a beauty house and a song campaign. All from a woman who, a few months earlier, was just bored on her phone.

The first thing I want you to understand

I did not have a niche, a content calendar or a media kit. I had something real to say about my life, at a moment people wanted to hear it, and I said it in a way that was mine. That was enough to start.

Everything else in this book came after. The strategy is how I turned that first spark into something that pays me, and kept it going once the news moved on. I am going to give you all of it, step by step, so you do not have to work it out the slow way.

If you are reading this bored, a little lost, and quietly sure you were made to create something, good. That is exactly where I was.

You post your life. Companies pay you for it.

That is the entire business. If you know nothing about this world yet, start here.

Companies used to pay for adverts. Now they pay women with an audience, because people trust a woman they follow more than an advert. You do not need to be famous. You need a clear account, beautiful videos and the confidence to ask.

Who pays you, and for what

WHO PAYS	WHAT YOU GET	WHAT YOU DO	CHAPTER
Hotels, resorts and villas	Free nights, meals and spa, then paid deals	Stay, film it beautifully, post it	06
Fashion, beauty and wellness brands	Free products, then paid campaigns	Wear or use it, film it, post it	07
Music labels and agencies	Cash for each Reel	Use their song in your Reel	08
Any brand that loves your results	Real money, by package	A set number of videos, to their brief	09–10

How it works, in five steps

01 **Decide what your account is about.** One clear idea, so a stranger gets it in two seconds.

02 **Make it beautiful.** One look, one set of colours, every post.

03 **Post short videos, often.** Four to five a week. This is how strangers find you.

04 **Email the hotels and brands you want.** I give you the exact email. Most people never ask. That is why most people never get.

05 **Deliver, show the results, ask for money next time.** The free stay is the audition. The paid deal comes after.

WORDS YOU WILL SEE IN THIS BOOK

Reel · a short vertical video on Instagram. TikTok has the same thing.
Insights · Instagram's page of your numbers: views, saves, shares, who watches.
PR box · free products a brand sends you, hoping you post them.
Hosted stay · a hotel gives you free nights in exchange for content.
Media kit · one page that shows brands who you are and your numbers.
Usage rights · permission for a brand to use your video in their own adverts. They pay extra for it.
CPM · what a brand pays to reach 1,000 people. Chapter Nine turns it into your price.

The receipts.

Before you take advice from anyone online, ask to see their numbers. Here are mine.

6.8M INSTAGRAM VIEWS IN THE LAST 90 DAYS	**2.73M** UNIQUE PEOPLE REACHED	**86.8%** OF THAT REACH FROM PEOPLE WHO DID NOT FOLLOW ME
11.1% ENGAGEMENT ON MY BEST FILM	**37.4K** INSTAGRAM FOLLOWERS	**32K** TIKTOK FOLLOWERS

And the part you actually bought this book for. In the last year I have made content with five-star resorts and private villas in Bali, restaurants and hotels in Dubai and Bangkok, wellness houses, fashion and activewear labels, a beauty house, and a music campaign for Jason Derulo. Aksari Ubud. Hotel Tugu. Alloura Villa. Cyrus Villa. Bubble Hotel. Pullman Bangkok Hotel G. At.mosphere at the Burj Khalifa. Dior Beauty. Kitty Activewear. Lumeira Bali with Bubblegum the Brand, which became a film with 879,000 views.

None of that started with an audience. It started with a few Reels in Dubai, made because I was bored. What turned them into a living was a reason, a look, and a rhythm I kept on the days I did not feel like it.

Who I was before this

I was licensed as a real estate agent at twenty-one in Manila, the youngest in every room at the country's largest developer, and consistently the top agent in the company. Five years of that. I closed multi-million dollar deals.

Then I spent three years in B2B digital marketing and built two marketing agencies, quietly. More than five hundred founder-led brands came through them. I spent years on the other side of the table, the side that hires creators, reads their pitches and decides who gets paid. That is the education this book is built on. I know what brands delete, and I know what they forward to their boss.

Today I run ALLAIA Media, I am COO at Blacklyne, and I split my life between Bali and Dubai. My personal brand pays for a large part of that life. It also pays me in a currency most people underestimate: the stays, the dinners, the treatments and the products I would have bought anyway.

What this book is, and what it is not

This is not a book about going viral. Viral is weather. You cannot plan for it, and building your life around it is how people burn out in month three.

This is a book about building a brand with architecture underneath it. A brand clear enough that strangers understand you in two seconds, consistent enough that brands trust you with their name, and valuable enough that you can send an email and get a yes.

Every template in here is the real one I use. Every number is from my own Insights. Where I give you a framework instead of a figure, it is because the honest answer depends on your market.

> ***A personal brand that pays you to exist is not luck. It is a reason, a look and a rhythm, kept long enough to compound.***

How to read this

Read it once, straight through. Then go back to Part Three with a notebook open, because that is where the money is, and it only works if Parts One and Two are done properly. The toolkit at the back is designed to be used, not admired. Copy the templates. Change the details. Send them.



PART ONE

The *architecture.*

What has to be true before a single post goes out.

You are not building an account. You are building a reason.

The single biggest mistake I see is a woman with taste, beauty and a good life posting all of it, and nobody following, because there is no reason to.

People do not follow accounts. They follow a reason. The reason is the answer to the only question a stranger asks in the two seconds before they scroll past you: *what will I get if I stay?*

"Lifestyle" is not a reason. "Travel" is not a reason. "My life in Bali" is not a reason, because there are ten thousand of those and the stranger does not know you yet. A reason is a specific promise, delivered in a specific way, by a specific woman.

The one sentence

Before anything else, you write one sentence. It has three parts.

THE POSITIONING SENTENCE

I help **[a specific woman]** feel / become / get **[a specific result]**, through **[the way only I do it]**.

Mine, in its shortest form, sits under everything I post: identity-led content for women who are tired of performing and ready to become who they actually are underneath, told through the life I am living in Bali and Dubai. The wellness, the hotels, the fashion and the discipline are all evidence for that one idea. That is why a five-star resort fits on my page, and a five-star resort's film can still be about standards, softness or self-respect.

Notice what that does. It means a brand is never the content. A brand is a setting for the content. That is precisely why brands want to be on my page. They are not buying an advert. They are buying a place inside a story their customer already believes.

Choose your three to five pillars

Your pillars are the recurring rooms of your brand. A follower should be able to predict them. A brand should be able to see where it fits. Mine, as they appear on my media kit:

PILLAR	WHAT IT IS	WHO PAYS FOR IT
Recovery and contrast therapy	Sauna, ice bath, cold plunge	Saunas, plunge tubs, recovery tech
Low-cortisol living	Sleep, slow mornings, the unglamorous basics	Adaptogens, sleep, magnesium
Fitness and movement	Strength, pilates, mobility	Activewear, equipment, studios
Holistic healing	Massage, lymphatic drainage, bodywork	Clinics, spas, at-home tools
Wellness travel	Retreats, spas, destinations built around feeling well	Hotels, retreats, destinations

See the third column. Most people choose pillars by asking what they like. I chose mine by asking what I like that someone also has a budget for. That is not cynical. It is the difference between a hobby and a brand that pays you to exist.

The identity test

Your positioning is right when it passes three tests.

01 **The stranger test.** Someone lands on your profile with no context. In under five seconds, from your name line, bio and first nine posts, can they say what you are about? Ask three people who do not know you well. If their answers do not match, it is not clear yet.

02 **The brand test.** Write down ten brands you would love to work with. Can you picture a film for each one that would sit naturally on your page? If you cannot, either the brands are wrong or the pillars are.

03 **The decade test.** Could you still post about this in ten years without feeling like a costume? Trends die. Identity compounds.

Your profile, rebuilt in an afternoon

- **Handle.** Short, sayable, the same on every platform if possible. Avoid numbers and underscores you have to explain.
- **Name line.** This is searchable on Instagram. Use your name plus your category, for example "Allaia · Wellness + Travel". It is a small change that makes you findable.
- **Bio, line one.** The reason. What they will get if they stay.
- **Bio, line two.** Proof or place. "Bali · Dubai", a book, a credential, a number.
- **Bio, line three.** One call to action. Collaborations go to an email. Everything else goes to one link.
- **Account type.** A creator account, not a business account, if music matters to you. Business accounts get a restricted music library, and Chapter Eight is built on music.
- **Highlights.** Three to five, named after your pillars, plus one called "Collabs" once you have them. That highlight is a quiet media kit that works while you sleep.

> *A brand is never the content. A brand is a setting for the content. That is why they want to be on your page.*

The aesthetic is a contract.

A hotel marketing manager decides whether to host you in about the time it takes to scroll your grid once. She is not reading your captions. She is asking one question: will my property look expensive here?

Your aesthetic is a promise. To your audience it says: this is the feeling you get here, every time. To a brand it says: this is exactly how your product will look, and you do not have to gamble on it. The tighter the promise, the easier the yes.

Choose a palette, and keep it

My world is warm. Cream, bone, terracotta, sage, deep brown, and black at night. Bali daylight or Dubai after dark, both leaning gold, never blue. When I film a resort, I film it at the hour that matches that palette, which is usually early morning or the last forty minutes of sun.

Pick yours with three questions:

01 What colours already dominate the places and clothes you love? Look at your camera roll, not at Pinterest.

02 What time of day do you look and feel best on camera?

03 What would the brands you want already approve of? Five-star hospitality is almost never neon.

Then edit everything to that palette. One preset or one set of manual adjustments, applied every time. Warm, slightly desaturated, consistent. Consistency is more valuable than any individual beautiful photo.

The wardrobe is part of the brand

I dress in a narrow range: black, cream, white, champagne, a little gold. It looks intentional on a grid and it photographs well in any hotel. It also means that when a fashion or activewear label sends pieces, they already fit the frame. You do not need more clothes. You need fewer, in the same family.

Three kinds of frames

Almost every film I post is built from three kinds of shots. Learn to collect them everywhere you go.

FRAME	WHAT IT DOES	EXAMPLE
The wide	Sets the place and the price point	The pool at golden hour, the city from the terrace
The ritual	Puts the viewer inside the experience	Pouring tea, stepping into the plunge, opening the curtains
The detail	Makes it feel expensive and tactile	Linen, cutlery, a hand on a glass, the texture of stone

Wide, ritual, detail. Repeat. That sequence alone will make an ordinary room look like a destination, and it is the sequence hotels quietly hope for when they say yes.

What I never post

- Blurry, badly lit or vertical-video-turned-sideways content, even when the moment was fun.
- Anything that looks like an advert before it looks like my life.
- Trends that do not fit the palette or the voice. Being on trend is worth less than being recognisable.
- A grid that lurches between aesthetics. Three off-brand posts can undo thirty good ones in the eyes of a brand.

> ***She is not reading your captions. She is asking one question: will my property look expensive here?***



PART TWO

The *attention.*

How the films are made, and how often.

Anatomy of a 619K film.

My best-performing film is called Escape The Matrix. 619,000 views. 51,200 likes. 10,900 saves. An 11.1% engagement rate, when sponsored content usually sits between one and three. Here is why it worked, so you can build your own.

Reach is not your follower count

Understand this first, because it changes everything. 86.8% of my reach in the last 90 days came from people who did not follow me. The platforms now show your films to strangers first and followers second. That means a new account is not at a disadvantage on any single film. You are competing film by film, not follower by follower.

It also means every film has one job: to make a stranger stop, stay and feel something. Here is how mine are built.

The structure I use

01 **The hook, zero to two seconds.** One line on screen and one striking image, both at once. The line is a provocation, a recognition or a question. "Escape the matrix." "Which one are you?" "She's a dangerous breed." Short. A little confronting. Impossible to answer without watching.

02 **The turn, two to six seconds.** The image changes and the line deepens. This is where you reward the stranger for stopping. If the first shot was the promise, the second is proof that you meant it.

03 **The body, six to twenty seconds.** Wide, ritual, detail. The text on screen carries the idea in two or three short lines. The visuals carry the feeling.

04 **The landing.** End on a line worth saving or sending. Not "follow for more." A sentence someone wants to keep, or a question that makes them tag a friend.

WHY THE NUMBERS WORKED

Saves mean "I want this again." **Shares** mean "this is me, or this is you." Escape The Matrix earned 10,900 saves because the idea was something women wanted to return to. Which one are you? earned 18,300 shares because the question demanded to be sent to someone. When you write your hook, decide which one you are designing for.

Hooks that work for this kind of brand

These are patterns, not scripts. Fill them with your own reason.

"The most expensive thing you can wear is..."	***"Nothing casual in my world."***
"You are not your record."	***"Which one are you?" (two or three types, shown one after another)***
"The power of keeping to yourself."	***"Competency is the standard."***
"On high standards."	***"Says who?"***

Each of those is a real title from one of my films, and between them they did well over a million views. Notice none of them mention a product. The hotel, the dress or the treatment appears inside the idea, never instead of it.

The text on screen

- One idea per film. If you need two ideas, you have two films.
- Short lines, large type, placed where the app interface will not cover them.
- Hold each line long enough to read twice.
- Write in sentence case, the way a woman speaks, not the way an advert shouts.

Sound

Sound is half of the film and most people choose it last. Choose it first. A rising, cinematic or emotionally specific sound, cut so the visual changes land on the beat, will lift an average film into a good one. And as you will see in Chapter Eight, the sound is also where some of the easiest money in this business lives.

The caption

The caption is for the people who already stayed. Open with one line that deepens the film. Then two or three short lines in your voice. Then one question that invites a reply, because replies tell the platform the film started a conversation. Hashtags matter less than they used to. Three to five specific ones are plenty. Tag the location and the brand, every time.

> ***You are competing film by film, not follower by follower. A new account is not at a disadvantage on any single film.***

CHAPTER 04 · CONSISTENCY

The rhythm. Ninety days of it.

My last nineteen published films averaged about 175,000 views each. Not because each one went viral. Because there were nineteen of them, and they all looked like they came from the same woman.

The middle of building a brand is the part nobody posts about. Films that do eight thousand views. Weeks where nothing moves. The same morning, the same edit, the same small promise kept on a Tuesday when nobody is watching. That middle is where the woman who is going to do it separates from the woman who keeps almost doing it.

You do not need motivation for the middle. You need a rhythm that is older than your mood.

The minimum rhythm

FORMAT	HOW OFTEN	WHY
Reels / TikToks	4 to 5 a week	This is where strangers find you
Carousels	1 to 2 a week	Saves, depth, and proof of your photography for brands
Stories	Most days	This is where followers start to trust you
One idea written down	Every day	So you never sit down to an empty page

Post the same film to Instagram and TikTok, without the other app's watermark. One shoot, two audiences. Today that is 37.4K on one and 32K on the other.

Batching: one day of shooting, one week of posts

01 **Sunday: ideas.** Write five hooks. Each one is a single line plus the shots it needs.

02 **One golden-hour session: shoot.** Two outfits, two locations, all five films. Collect wides, rituals and details for every one.

03 **One evening: edit.** Same preset, same type, same pacing. Schedule them.

04 **Daily, fifteen minutes: stories and replies.** Reply to every comment in the first hour after a post.

When you travel, you shoot more than you need. A three-night hotel stay can supply two weeks of content if you collect frames properly, and that is part of what you are offering the hotel too.

The ninety-day frame

Commit to ninety days before you judge anything. Not thirty. In thirty days you are still learning your own editing software. Somewhere between day forty and day seventy, if you are posting at the rhythm above, one film will travel further than the rest. When it does, you will need forty other films on your profile for the strangers who arrive, so they have a reason to stay.

THE RULE I KEEP

Discipline is choosing the woman you are becoming. Not the mood you are in. The rhythm decides on the days your mood would not.

Read your numbers like an operator.

I spent years running agencies. Brands do not care about your feelings about a post. They care about four numbers, and once you understand them, so will you.

NUMBER	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	WHAT TO DO WITH IT
Views and reach	Did the hook work on strangers	Low reach means rewrite the first two seconds
Non-follower %	Is the platform pushing you outward	The higher it is, the more you can charge for discovery
Saves	Did it hold value after watching	Make more of whatever gets saved
Shares / sends	Did it become someone's message to a friend	The strongest growth signal you have

Engagement rate, properly

Add likes, comments, saves and shares. Divide by views. Multiply by a hundred. That is the engagement rate I quote, and it is the one brands increasingly ask for. Mine peaked at 11.1%. Anything above 5% on a film is strong. Anything below 2% means the film was watched but not felt.

The weekly review

Every Sunday, before writing next week's hooks, I open Insights and answer three questions in my notes:

01 Which film had the highest saves plus shares per view?

02 What was its hook, and what was its sound?

03 What will I make next week that uses the same idea in a new setting?

That is the whole system. You are not guessing. You are running small experiments and keeping the winners.

Screenshot everything

From day one, screenshot the Insights of every film that does well, and of your account overview every month. Views, reach, saves, shares, audience age, gender and cities. In Part Three these screenshots become your media kit. Brands trust a screenshot more than a sentence.

> ***You are not guessing. You are running small experiments and keeping the winners.***



PART THREE

The *money.*

Stays, products, songs and cheques. Exactly how I ask.

Five-star hotels, on the house.

This is the chapter most people buy the book for, so I will be direct. Luxury hotels and private villas host creators every week. They do it because a beautiful film is cheaper and more convincing than an advert. The creators who get hosted are not always the biggest. They are the clearest, the most beautiful on the grid, and the easiest to say yes to.

When you are ready to ask

You do not need a hundred thousand followers. You need three things:

- A grid that would make the hotel look expensive. Chapter Two.
- At least a few films with strong views, so you can show reach. Chapter Three.
- Proof you can shoot a place. If you have never been hosted, film a beautiful café, restaurant or day spa you paid for, exactly as you would film a hotel, and tag them. That is your first portfolio piece.

Look at my own work. Before Aksari Ubud, Cyrus Villa and Hotel Tugu, there were films for Ferro in Ubud, Kinoa and Nude in Berawa. The resorts were easier to say yes to because those smaller films existed.

Start one level below where you want to be, and do it beautifully.

Who to email

Find the contact on the property's own website, official fact sheet or press page. Never guess an address from a pattern. In order of preference:

01 The PR, marketing or communications contact.

02 The general information address.

03 Reservations, as a last resort, asking them to forward it.

Many private villas are run by management companies. If you find that several villas share one company, pitch the company once rather than emailing them five times. Keep a simple spreadsheet: property, area, email, date sent, follow-up dates, status. I track every pitch in one sheet with a status for each: queued, sent, followed up, replied, bounced. It is boring. It is also why nothing falls through the cracks.

The pitch that works

Here is the structure of the email I send. The full template is in the toolkit at the back, word for word.

01 **Subject:** "three ways we could work together, [property]". Lowercase, personal, not salesy.

02 **Who I am, in one line,** plus one specific, true detail about their property that shows I know it. Not "your beautiful hotel." Their sky villas, their spa ritual, their view over the bay.

03 **When.** A specific date window. Hotels plan. "I'll be in Phuket anytime between December 8 and 20" is easy to schedule. "Sometime soon" is easy to ignore.

04 **What I'd create.** One cinematic Reel, potentially as a Collab Post. One carousel of styled photography. Three to five Stories. Optional extra short-form assets, separately negotiated.

05 **Three ways to work together.** 1. Hosted stay with organic usage rights. 2. Paid partnership with full usage rights. 3. Both.

06 **Proof.** Followers, views in the last 90 days, and two named features with their numbers.

07 **Media kit link.**

08 **The close:** "Just reply 1, 2 or 3 and I'll take it from there."

WHY "REPLY 1, 2 OR 3" WORKS

A marketing manager reading on her phone does not want to write a paragraph. A number takes one second. It also quietly puts a paid partnership on the table in the very first email, without asking "what is your budget", which is the question every brand hates. Some will choose 1. Some will choose 2. You will be surprised how many choose 3.

Follow up, twice, kindly

Most yeses come from a follow-up, not the first email. I send two, as replies in the same thread:

- **Day 3:** a short note floating it back up, restating the dates.
- **Day 7:** a last note, saying I am planning my stays now, and thanking them either way.

Then I stop. An auto-reply is not a reply, so the follow-ups still go. A human "no" or "please use our form" is a reply, so nothing more goes. Never chase a third time.

Volume, honestly

This is a numbers game played with good manners. When I plan a trip, I pitch every five-star resort and luxury villa in the area, in batches across the working day, capped so it stays personal: at most twenty new pitches a day, and thirty-five emails a day including follow-ups. Each one has its own specific detail. If you send five emails and wait, you will decide it does not work. If you send fifty excellent ones, you will be choosing between offers.

When they say yes

01 Confirm in writing: dates, room or villa category, number of nights, meals or treatments included, and exactly what you will deliver and by when.

02 Ask if there is anything they would love you to feature, a new restaurant, a spa ritual, a suite.

03 Arrive with a shot list. Wide, ritual, detail, at golden hour.

04 Deliver early. Then read Chapter Ten, because the stay is not the end. It is the audition.

> ***If you send five emails and wait, you will decide it does not work. If you send fifty excellent ones, you will be choosing between offers.***

PR boxes, and how gifted becomes paid.

My first film for Kitty Activewear did 562,000 views. Four more films followed. That is how product collaborations are supposed to work: a gift that turns into a relationship.

How PR lists actually work

Brands keep lists of creators they send products to, usually managed by a PR, influencer or community person. Getting on a list is less about size and more about fit. They want women whose audience is their customer, whose feed makes their product look premium, and who post what they receive.

Getting on the list

01 **Post the brands you already own,** tagged, filmed as beautifully as a paid job. This is how brands discover you before you ever email them.

02 **Check they ship to you.** Before pitching, look at the brand's own shipping or checkout page. If they do not deliver to your country, do not waste the email.

03 **Find the right contact:** a PR, influencer or creator email for your region, then the global one, then press or collabs addresses on the official site. Some brands only accept applications through a form. Use it.

04 **Pitch with the same structure** as the hotel email: who you are, what you would create, three ways to work together (gifted, paid, both), proof, media kit, reply 1, 2 or 3.

Stay in your price point

Not every box is a good box. I only take beauty and fragrance from luxury houses. Saying yes to everything that arrives is the fastest way to make your page look like a discount aisle, and the luxury brands are watching. The yes you give a cheap brand can cost you a no from an expensive one.

From gifted to paid

A gifted collaboration should come with organic usage rights only. That means they can repost your post, credited, on their own page. It does not mean they can run your film as a paid advert, use it on their website, or cut it into a campaign. Those are paid usage rights, and they are where the money is.

When a gifted film performs, you send this, in your own words:

"The film for [brand] reached [views] people, with [saves] saves and [shares] shares, and 86% of that reach was new audience. I would love to build on it. I put together two options for a paid campaign this season, including full usage rights so your team can run it as ads."

Gifted is the trial. Results are the negotiation. That is how a box of leggings turns into five films and a standing relationship.

> ***Gifted is the trial. Results are the negotiation.***

Getting paid to use a song.

You already put a sound on every film. Some creators are paid to choose that sound. I made a film for Jason Derulo's Sexy For You campaign. It is the simplest paid work in this industry, and almost nobody outside it knows it exists.

Why labels pay for this

A song becomes a hit on short-form video when enough people hear it attached to images they love. Every film that uses the official sound sends viewers to that sound's page, where more creators find it and use it. Labels, artists and music marketing agencies pay creators to start that chain, because a sound that trends becomes streams, and streams become money for them.

How a song campaign usually works

01 **The brief.** You are sent the track, often a specific section of it, and the feeling they want. Sometimes a dance or a trend, more often a mood they want to sit behind.

02 **The rules.** Use the official audio, not a re-upload. Use it for a minimum length. Keep the post up for a set period. Sometimes tag the artist or use a specific hashtag. Always disclose it as paid.

03 **The film.** Your normal content, in your normal aesthetic, with their sound. The best campaign films do not look like campaigns. They look like your best film, which happened to use that song.

04 **The proof.** You send the link and, usually, a screenshot of views after a set number of days.

05 **The payment.** Usually a flat fee per post, sometimes with bonuses tied to views. The fee depends on your average views, your audience and how much the campaign needs your exact niche.

How to get into music campaigns

- **Be on a creator account,** so the full music library is open to you.
- **Show you can make a sound move.** Use trending and rising sounds early, cut your edits on the beat, and keep the films where the sound was the star.
- **Join the rosters.** Music marketing agencies and creator marketplaces run these campaigns and keep lists of creators by niche and average views. Search for music marketing and influencer campaign agencies, look for their "creators" or "join our network" pages, and apply with your stats.
- **Email them directly** with a short note: your niche, your average views per film, your audience's age, gender and top cities, and two films where the music carried the moment. The template is in the toolkit.

— **Say yes to the right songs.** A campaign for a track that does not fit your world will cost you more in trust than it pays. Mine have to fit the palette, the mood and the woman.

WHY THIS ONE COMPOUNDS

A music campaign takes the same hour as any other film. It does not need travel, products or a shot list. Once you are on a few rosters, briefs arrive on their own. It is the closest thing in this book to being paid simply for continuing to post.

> ***You already put a sound on every film. Some creators are paid to choose that sound.***

The media kit and the rate card.

Know your worth. Then charge it. That sentence is my tagline for a reason. Most creators undercharge because they price their time. Brands do not buy your time. They buy reach, trust and the right to use your work.

What goes in a media kit

One page, or one web page. Mine lives at allaiamedia.com/brand-collabs and is linked in every pitch. Yours can start as a beautiful PDF.

- **Who you are,** in one line, with a portrait that matches your grid.
- **The proof band:** followers per platform, views in the last 90 days, unique reach, non-follower %, best engagement rate. Each with a sentence on what it buys the brand.
- **Your audience:** age band, gender split and top cities, straight from Insights.
- **Your pillars,** and which kinds of brands fit each one.
- **Past work:** every film you are proud of, with the real numbers it did.
- **Packages,** named, with what is included. Prices can live on request.
- **Contact:** one email.

How I reason about price

The industry measures social advertising in CPM, the cost to reach a thousand people. A common planning figure is around ten US dollars per thousand views. So the simplest honest starting point is this:

THE BASE FORMULA

Your conservative views per film ÷ 1,000 × CPM = **the media value of one film**

On my media kit, I plan with 150,000 views per film even though my actual trailing average is about 175,000, so the projection under-promises. 150,000 ÷ 1,000 × $10 = $1,500 of media value, before anything else is added.

Then you add:

- **Production.** Concept, script, styling, shooting, editing. A brand would pay a studio far more for this than for the posting.
- **Usage rights.** If they can run it as an ad or on their website, that is worth a meaningful premium, and more again for full rights without time limits.
- **Exclusivity.** If you agree not to work with their competitor, that has a price.
- **Extras:** Stories with link stickers, a discount or affiliate code, reporting.

Use your own conservative number, your own market's CPM and your own costs. A smaller creator with exceptional engagement and a premium niche can rightly charge more than the formula. A large creator with a disengaged audience should charge less. The formula is a floor for your thinking, not a ceiling for your worth.

Packages, not prices

Never send a single number. Send choices. Mine are three:

PACKAGE	WHAT IT IS	BEST FOR
The Single	One film, concept to post, full usage, a performance recap	A launch moment, or testing the channel
The Campaign	Three films over six weeks, Stories with links, a code, mid and end reporting	A launch where one post will not move stock
The Ambassador	Six or more films a quarter, category exclusivity, a strategy call	Owning a category with my audience

Three options change the question in the brand's head from "should we work with her" to "which one do we choose." The middle one is the one most people take, so make the middle one the one you most want.

Getting paid, properly

- Everything in writing before you shoot: deliverables, dates, usage, payment amount and terms.
- For new clients, ask for half upfront and half on delivery.

- Invoice on the day you deliver. Include your bank details and the payment deadline.
- Keep a simple folder for each brand: the brief, the agreement, the film, the stats, the invoice.

> ***Know your worth. Then charge it.***

The second email. Turning a stay into a cheque.

The first collaboration is an audition. The money is in the second one. Most creators never send the email that gets it.

Deliver more than you promised

If you promised one Reel, one carousel and three to five Stories, deliver all of it on time, then send a small folder of extra raw photos and clips the brand can use organically. It costs you nothing, because you shot it anyway. It makes you the easiest creator they have ever worked with.

The recap

Seven days after your film goes live, send a recap. Every time. Almost nobody does this, and it is the most valuable email you will write.

- Screenshots of the film's Insights: views, reach, saves, shares, likes.
- The percentage of reach from non-followers. To a hotel, that is new guests.
- Any comments asking where it is, how to book or what it costs.
- One line on what you would do next time.

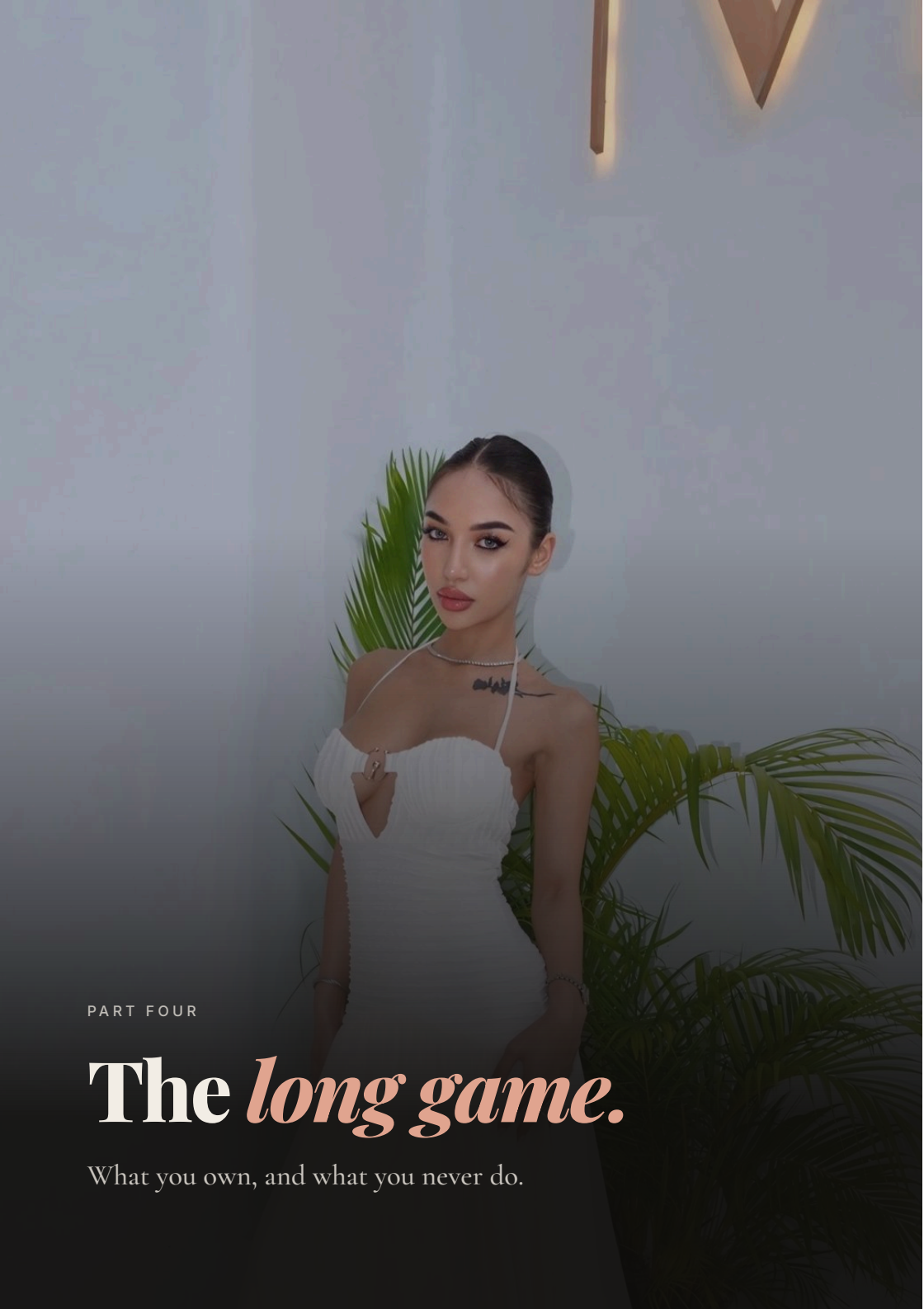
The second email

Inside that recap, you open the door. Something like this, in your own words:

> *"Thank you again for having me. The film reached [views] people and is still travelling. I would love to do this properly next season, with a paid package built around [the new restaurant, the spa launch, the festive period]. I've attached two options. Happy to adjust to whatever your team is planning."*

Every property that hosted me is now a warm lead, and so is every brand I have featured. A warm lead converts far more often than a cold one. If you are serious about this becoming income, the people who already said yes are your first list.

> ***The first collaboration is an audition. The money is in the second one.***



PART FOUR

The *long game.*

What you own, and what you never do.

Own the attention you earn.

You do not own your followers. The platform does. One change in an algorithm and your reach halves overnight. The women who last are the women who turn rented attention into something they own.

Three things to build while you grow

01 **An email list.** Start it on day one, even with ten people. One link in bio, one reason to join: a free guide, a weekly note, early access. An email reaches the inbox. A post reaches whoever the algorithm decides.

02 **Something to sell.** A guide, a preset, an ebook like this one, a course, a session. It does not need to be big. It needs to be the natural next step for someone who loves your content. Mine are a book, Become Her, and a small private practice. They live on one link, stan.store/allaia, so nobody has to think.

03 **A home.** A simple website with your story, your media kit and your products. When a five-star resort's marketing team looks you up, they should land somewhere that looks like a business.

Why this changes the brand deals too

When your income does not depend on any single brand saying yes, you start choosing. You say no to the wrong product. You hold your price. You pitch the property you actually want, not the one that will have you. Brands can feel that, and they pay more for it. Freedom is not the result of the money. Freedom is what lets you charge it.

The rules I keep.

The fastest way to lose a personal brand is to treat it as a hustle. These are the lines I do not cross. They are why brands come back.

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01 **Never buy followers, likes or views,** and never join engagement groups. Brands check, the numbers stop making sense, and the platform punishes it.

02 **Always disclose.** Paid, gifted or hosted, say so clearly, with the platform's paid partnership label and a plain "ad", "gifted" or "hosted" at the start of the caption. In the US this is required by the FTC, in the UK by the ASA, and other countries have their own rules. In the UAE, paid promotion requires an advertiser permit from the UAE Media Council. Check the rules where you live and where you post from.

03 **Only promote what you would use anyway.** I test anything health-related on myself for weeks before I mention it. Your audience's trust is the asset. Every brand is renting it. Do not sell it cheap.

04 **Deliver on time, every time.** In an industry where many creators ghost after a free stay, being reliable is a competitive advantage.

05 **Never answer for someone else.** Every collaboration goes through you or someone you have explicitly trusted with it.

06 **Never use a song, image or clip you do not have the right to use** in a paid post. Use the official audio in the app and your own footage.

07 **Keep your price.** When a brand asks for a discount, change the package, not the price. Fewer deliverables, shorter usage, no exclusivity.

08 **Protect the woman underneath.** You are allowed to be private. The brand is a curated room in your life, not the whole house.

A last note

The before is a great story. The after is a great photo. The middle is the part nobody films. It is the eleventh Tuesday of posting to a few thousand views. It is the fortieth email with no reply. It is the hotel that says no, and the one, three weeks later, that says yes.

Everything in this book works. But it works the way architecture works, slowly and then all at once. Build the reason. Keep the look. Hold the rhythm. Send the emails. Deliver more than you promised. And when the first five-star yes lands in your inbox, remember this moment, because you will want to tell the next woman exactly how you did it.

Know your worth. Then charge it.
— Allaia

The 30-day launch plan.

The first thirty days of your ninety. Tick them off. Do not skip ahead.

Week one · The architecture

- [ ] Write your positioning sentence. Test it on three people.
- [ ] Choose three to five pillars, with the brands that pay for each.
- [ ] Switch to a creator account. Rewrite your name line and bio.
- [ ] Choose your palette and build one editing preset.
- [ ] Archive anything on your grid that breaks the palette.
- [ ] Write a list of 30 hooks.
- [ ] Start your email list with one free reason to join.

Week two · The first films

- [ ] Batch-shoot five films in one golden-hour session.
- [ ] Post four to five Reels, cross-posted to TikTok.

- [ ] Post one carousel.
- [ ] Stories most days.
- [ ] Reply to every comment within the first hour.
- [ ] Film one café, restaurant or spa you paid for, as if you were hosted. Tag them.

Week three · The system

- [ ] First Sunday review: best saves plus shares per view, and why.
- [ ] Make three more films on that winning idea.
- [ ] Screenshot all Insights. Start your proof folder.
- [ ] Post the brands you already own, tagged and beautifully shot.
- [ ] Apply to three music campaign rosters.

Week four · The first asks

- [ ] Build your one-page media kit.
- [ ] Build your pitch spreadsheet: twenty properties or brands in your area, with verified contacts.
- [ ] Send the first ten pitches, each with one specific detail.
- [ ] Follow up on day three and day seven.

- [ ] Write your three packages, even if you do not send prices yet.
- [ ] Book your next golden-hour shoot.

TOOLKIT · APPENDIX B

Every template I use, word for word.

Copy these. Change the brackets. Keep the structure. Replace my numbers with yours, and never claim a number you cannot screenshot.

1 · Hotel, resort or villa pitch

Subject: three ways we could work together, [Property]

Hi [Name / Team],

I'm [Your name] (@[handle]), a luxury travel & lifestyle creator based in [city], and [one true, specific detail about the property, e.g. your sky villas over the bay have] been on my list for a while. I'll be in [area] anytime between [date] and [date], and I'd love to feature a stay with you.

I handle everything — concept, shooting and production — so you receive beautiful lifestyle photos and films you can repost on your own channels.

What I'd create:
— 1 cinematic Instagram Reel, potentially as a Collab Post
— 1 carousel of professionally styled photography
— 3–5 Instagram Stories documenting the experience
— Optional short-form video assets for your social channels, separately negotiated

Three ways we could work together:
1. Hosted stay — the content above, with organic usage rights
2. Paid partnership — a content package built to your brief, full usage rights
3. Both

[X] followers on Instagram and [X] on TikTok, with [X] Instagram views in the last 90 days. Recent features: [Property] ([X] views) and [Property] ([X]).

Media kit: [link]

Just reply 1, 2 or 3 and I'll take it from there.

[Your name]
@[handle]

2 · Follow-up, day 3

Hi [Name],

Floating this back up in case it got buried. I'm planning my stays for [date] to [date] and would love to include [Property].

Just reply 1, 2 or 3 and I'll take it from there.

[Your name]

3 · Follow-up, day 7

Hi [Name],

A last note from me — I'm finalising my stays for [date] to [date]. If a collaboration with [Property] could work, just reply 1, 2 or 3 and I'll take it from there. Either way, thank you for your time.

[Your name]

4 · Brand and PR pitch

Subject: three ways we could work together, [Brand]

Hi [Name / Team],

I'm [Your name] (@[handle]), a [niche] creator based in [city], with content focused on [your pillars]. I'd love to create content with [Brand].

I handle everything — concept, styling, shooting and production — so you receive beautiful lifestyle content you can repost on your own channels.

What I'd create:
— 1 cinematic Instagram Reel, potentially as a Collab Post
— 1 carousel of professionally styled photography
— 3–5 Instagram Stories
— Optional short-form video assets for your ads and social channels, separately negotiated

Three ways we could work together:
1. Gifted collab — you send pieces to [city], I create the content above, with organic usage rights
2. Paid partnership — a content package built to your brief, full usage rights
3. Both

[X] followers on Instagram and [X] on TikTok, with [X] Instagram views in the last 90 days. Recent collabs: [Brand] ([X] views) and [Brand] ([X]).

Media kit: [link]

Just reply 1, 2 or 3 and I'll take it from there.

[Your name]
@[handle]

5 · Music campaign roster email

Subject: creator for your music campaigns — [niche], [X] avg views

Hi [Name / Team],

I'm [Your name] (@[handle]), a [niche] creator on Instagram and TikTok. I'd love to be considered for your music campaigns.

— Average views per film, last 90 days: [X]
— Audience: [X]% women, mostly [age band], top cities [cities]
— Two films where the sound carried the moment: [link], [link]

My films are cinematic and mood-led, so they suit [genres or moods] best. I'm happy to work to a brief, use the official audio and disclose every post.

[Your name]
@[handle] · [media kit link]

6 · Recap and the second email

Subject: your film, one week in

Hi [Name],

Thank you again for [having me / the pieces]. Here's how the film is doing, one week in:

— Views: [X]
— Reach: [X], of which [X]% were new to my page
— Saves: [X] · Shares: [X] · Likes: [X]
— Screenshots attached, plus a folder of extra photos and clips you're welcome to use on your own channels.

I'd love to build on this next season with a paid package around [their launch, season or new offer]. I've attached two options, and I'm happy to shape them to whatever your team is planning.

[Your name]

7 · Turning gifted into paid

Hi [Name],

The film for [Brand] reached [X] people, with [X] saves and [X] shares, and [X]% of that reach was new audience. I'd love to build on it. I've put together two options for a paid campaign this season, including full usage rights so your team can run it as ads.

[Your name]

8 · Your rate card skeleton

The Single — one film, concept to post, full usage, performance recap. [Price on request / your price]

The Campaign — three films over six weeks, supporting Stories with links, a discount or affiliate code, mid and end reporting. [Price]

The Ambassador — six or more films per quarter, category exclusivity, first look at new products, quarterly strategy call. [Price]

Planning maths: conservative views per film ÷ 1,000 × CPM = media value. Add production, usage, exclusivity and extras.
